

R26 TIME WORDS

English has lots of words to talk about when things happen. They usually act as prepositions, conjunctions, or adverbs.

TIME WORD	USE	SAMPLE SENTENCE
about to	shows an event will happen very soon	The train on platform 6 is about to leave.
after	shows an event in the main clause follows another event	Wash your hands after you've been gardening.
already	shows an event has happened before another event or a particular time	Don't worry, I've already ordered some food.
as	indicates an event happens at the same time as another event	It started raining as we were leaving the house.
as soon as	indicates an event (in the main clause) happens straight after another event	Please call us as soon as you arrive in New York.
before	shows an event (in the main clause) precedes another event	I was a teacher before I became a politician.
by the time	shows an event precedes or happens at the same time as an event in the main clause	By the time we arrived, the game had started.
eventually	shows an event happened after a long time	It was a long wait, but eventually our exam results arrived.
finally	indicates an event at the end of a list / sequence, or that happened after a long time	I'd like to thank my family, my team, and finally my fans.
in the end	shows an event happened after a long time	Joe took the exam three times, but in the end he passed.
just	shows an event happened very recently	Quick! I've just seen something really amazing!
later	indicates an event after the time of speaking or the time that is being talked about	I can't take you to the mall now. We'll go there later .
meanwhile	indicates an event happens at the same time as another event	The show started at 8. Meanwhile , we went for dinner.
next	indicates an event in a sequence	Stir the melted chocolate. Next , pour it into the cake pan.
once	indicates an event starts to happen (in the main clause) after another one	Once you've cleaned the stove, wipe all the handles.
since	shows an event continuing from a past time to the present	I haven't seen you since we were in school!
still	shows an event at the time of speaking started in the past and is continuing	Are they still repairing the main road?
then	indicates an event in a sequence, or one event that happens after another	We went to the cinema, then we went out for a meal.
until	shows an event continues up to the time of another event	I won't stop saving until I've bought a new car.
when	shows an event happens at the same time as or after another event	Could you call me when all the salespeople have arrived?
while	indicates an event happens at the same time as another event	Please don't interrupt me while I'm trying to concentrate.
yet	shows an expected event has not happened, or asks whether it has happened	Have you finished the sales report yet ?